

LIGHTWEIGHT RACERS

ORNITHOMIMUS

The ostrichlike **Ornithomimus** belonged to a group of long-limbed theropods called ornithomimids who shared one crucial trait: speed. With their long legs powered by strong muscles and lean, lightweight bodies, ornithomimids were probably the fastest dinosaurs to race across the face of the Earth. Paleontologists have found fossils of many ornithomimids preserved together, which suggests that these swift theropods may have moved around in small groups, possibly as a way to help keep an eye out for predators.

FASTEST
DINOSAURS

The tail helped these theropods balance their weight while running.

Like all dinosaurs, *Ornithomimus* walked on its toes.

